

How to Discern the Sacred

In Paul's day, the Judaizers tried to weaken the **gospel**. They claimed it was less righteous than the Law. Today, a similar pressure exists. Post-modern culture pushes the gospel into the category of personal belief; non-rational, unscientific, and subjective.

This raises an important question. *Why is the divide between sacred and secular so strong? Why are so many misled? And what is needed to see clearly?*

Paul was not ashamed of the gospel. He calls it **"the power of God for salvation for everyone who believes"** (Romans 1:16, NET). The gospel is not opinion. It is God's revealed plan for redeeming mankind. Paul describes this plan as wisdom revealed by God:

1 Corinthians 2:6–10 (NET). *"Now we do speak wisdom among the mature, but not a wisdom of this age or of the rulers of this age, who are perishing. Instead, we speak the wisdom of God, hidden in a mystery, that God determined before the ages for our glory... God has revealed these to us by the Spirit. For the Spirit searches all things, even the deep things of God."*

The gospel reveals more than a plan. It reveals God Himself; His character, His righteousness, and His purpose. Through the Spirit, what was once hidden is now made known. But this understanding is not automatic.

1 Corinthians 2:14–16 (NET). *"The unbeliever does not receive the things of the Spirit of God, for they are foolishness to him... But we have the mind of Christ."*

Spiritual truth must be discerned spiritually. It is received by those who respond to God with the **"obedience of faith"** (Romans 1:5). Without that response, the gospel is dismissed as foolishness. Paul anchors this in Habakkuk:

Romans 1:17 (NET). *"For the righteousness of God is revealed in the gospel from faith to faith, just as it is written, 'The righteous by faith will live.'"*

So, who are the righteous? They are those who live by faith; faith that trusts, submits, and responds to God. This same truth is echoed in Hebrews 10:38 and Galatians 3:11. The result is practical. The sacred is no longer hidden. It shapes how we live.

Romans 12:1–2 (NET). *"Therefore, I exhort you... to present your bodies as a sacrifice; alive, holy, and pleasing to God... Do not be conformed to this present world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind..."*

The line between sacred and secular is not erased; it is clarified. The gospel teaches us to discern what is truly from God and to live it out daily. This is the **obedience of faith**.

Further Study...

- <https://tinyurl.com/GodOfPromises>
- <https://tinyurl.com/RightWithGod>
- <https://tinyurl.com/RomeGospel>
- <https://tinyurl.com/Call2Unity>

